



# LECTURE 10 – PART 03

## BUSINESS CHARTS IN EXCEL

### For Stakeholder Reporting & Data Storytelling

#### 1. What is a Business Chart?

A business chart is a visual representation of data used to communicate insights, patterns, trends, comparisons and relationships to stakeholders for better decision making.



Goal is not to use maximum charts, but to use the **RIGHT** chart for the **RIGHT** question.

#### 2. Who are Stakeholders?

People or groups who are interested in the results of your analysis.

- CEO → Overall Performance, Growth, KPIs
- CFO → Profitability, Cost, Budget, ROI
- Sales Manager → Sales Trends, Targets, Pipeline
- Marketing Manager → Campaign Performance, Leads, ROI
- Operations Manager → Efficiency, Process, SLA, Issues
- HR Manager → Employee Performance, Attrition
- Risk / Fraud Team → Risk, Fraud %, Anomalies
- Clients / Investors → Returns, Stability, Key Metrics

#### 3. Identify the Business Question First

| Analytical Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Example Business Question                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Comparison</li><li>Ranking</li><li>Trend</li><li>Part-to-Whole</li><li>Target vs Actual</li><li>Variance / Bridge</li><li>Relationship</li><li>Distribution</li><li>Outliers</li><li>Geography</li><li>Hierarchy</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>→ Which region performs best?</li><li>→ What are our top 10 products?</li><li>→ Is revenue increasing over time?</li><li>→ Where does revenue come from?</li><li>→ Are we meeting our targets?</li><li>→ Why did profit change?</li><li>→ Does discount affect profit?</li><li>→ How are transaction amounts distributed?</li><li>→ Are there unusual transactions?</li><li>→ Where are sales concentrated?</li><li>→ Which category / subcategory drives sales?</li></ul> |

#### What do Stakeholders Need?

- ☆ Clear insights quickly
- ☆ Simple & easy to understand visuals
- ☆ Focus on important metrics
- ☆ Trends, comparisons & reasons
- ☆ Actionable insights for decisions

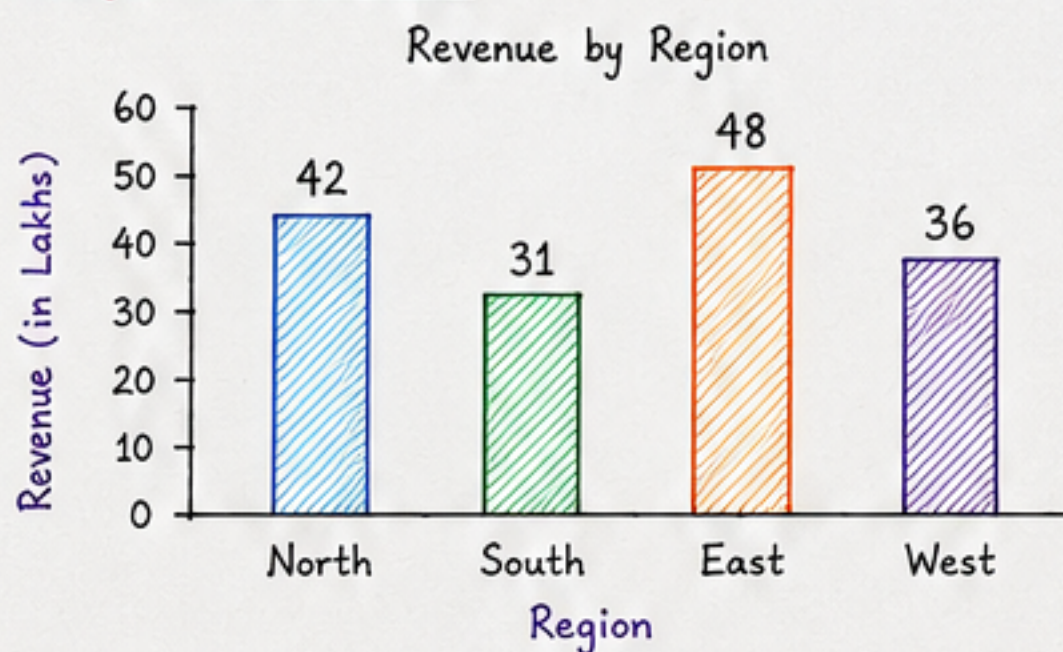
#### 4. Column Chart (Category Comparison)

##### When to Use?

- Compare values across categories.
- Best when categories are few.

##### Use Cases

- Revenue by Region
- Sales by Product
- Orders by Category
- Profit by Department



##### Business Question

Which region generates the highest revenue?

##### Key Insights

- East has the highest revenue (48 Lakhs).
- South has the lowest revenue (31 Lakhs).
- Focus on improving South region performance.

#### 5. Bar Chart (Ranking)

##### When to Use?

- For ranking / Top N analysis.
- Best for long category names.
- Comparing many items.

##### Use Cases

- Top 10 Products
- Top Merchants
- Employee Performance



##### Key Insight

Product A is our top performer while Product E has lowest sales.

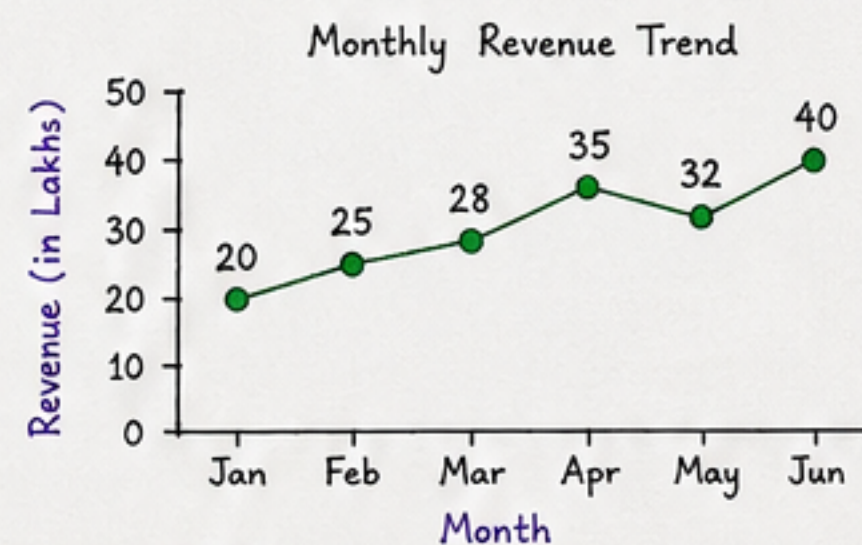
#### 6. Line Chart (Trend Over Time)

##### When to Use?

- Show trends over time.
- Identify growth, decline or seasonality.
- Best for continuous data.

##### Use Cases

- Monthly Revenue Trend
- Daily Transactions
- Stock Prices
- Customer Growth



##### Key Insights

- Overall trend is increasing.
- June shows highest revenue (40 Lakhs).



# BUSINESS CHARTS IN EXCEL

## For Stakeholder Reporting & Data Storytelling



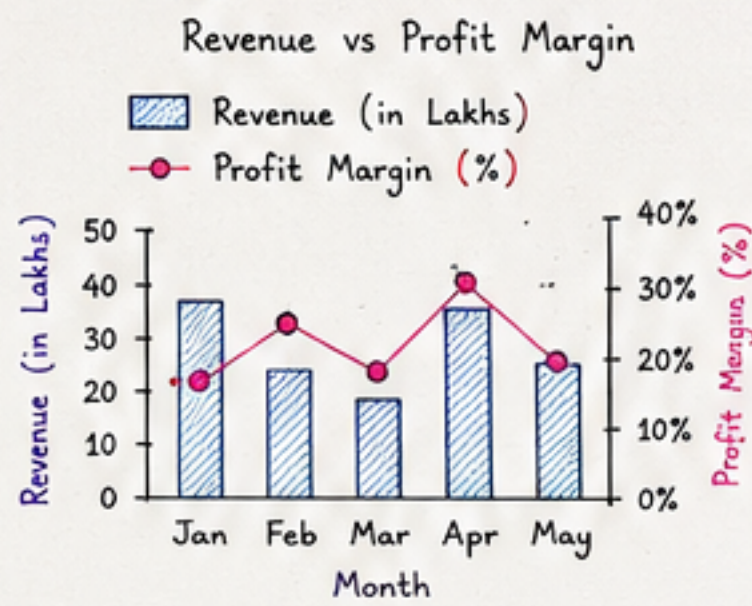
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### 7. Combo Chart (Two Metrics Together)

#### When to Use?

- When you want to compare two different metrics.
- When one metric is in % or different scale.

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Revenue vs Profit Margin
- Sales vs Growth %
- Orders vs Return Rate

#### Key Insight

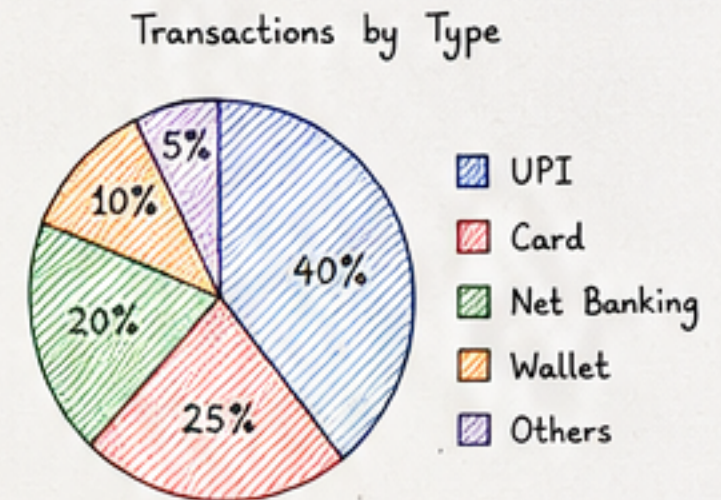
Revenue is increasing overall but profit margin dropped in May. Need to investigate.

### 8. Pie Chart (Part-to-Whole)

#### When to Use?

- Show contribution of each category to total.
- Best when there are few categories (5 or less).

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Sales by Channel
- Market Share
- Expense Breakdown
- Transaction Type Distribution

#### Key Insight

UPI contributes the most (40%) followed by Card payments (25%).

#### Avoid When

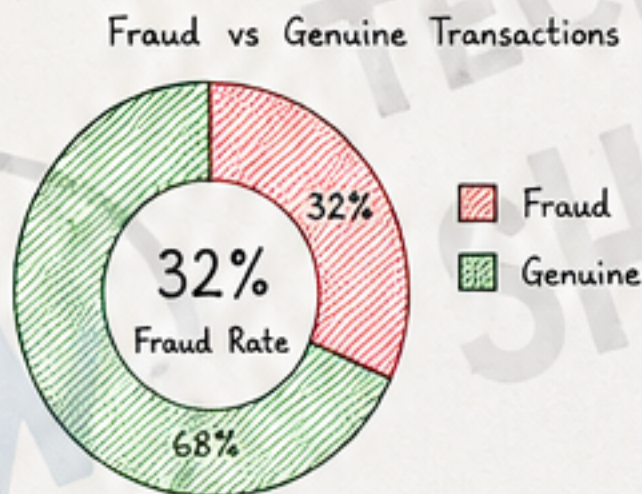
Too many categories - it becomes hard to compare.

### 9. Doughnut Chart (KPI + Part-to-Whole)

#### When to Use?

- Similar to pie chart.
- Best for dashboards with KPI in center.

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Sales by Channel with KPI
- Budget Utilization with KPI

#### Key Insight

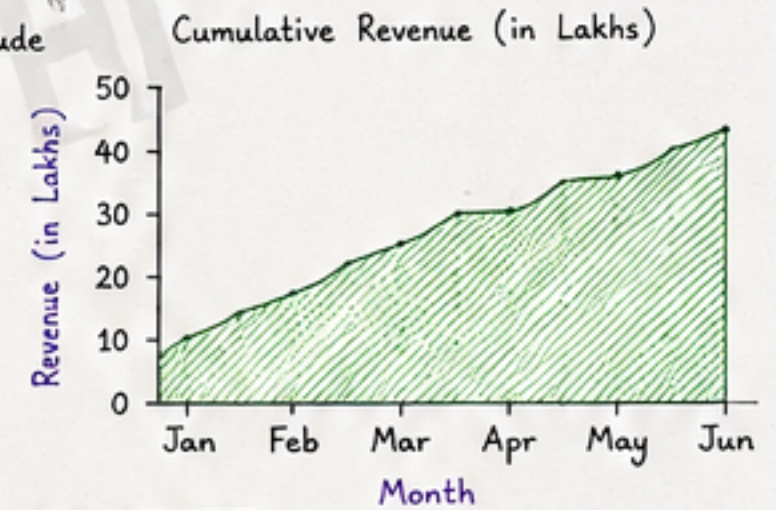
Fraud rate is 32%. We need to reduce it.

### 10. Area Chart (Magnitude Over Time)

#### When to Use?

- Show volume or magnitude change over time.
- Emphasizes the total value.

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Cumulative Revenue
- Website Traffic
- Inventory Level Over Time
- Customer Base Growth

#### Key Insight

Revenue is growing consistently and reached highest in June.

### 11. Scatter Chart (Relationship)

#### When to Use?

- To find relationship between two numeric variables.
- To identify patterns, correlation & outliers.

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Discount vs Profit
- Age vs Spending
- Advertising Spend vs Revenue

#### Key Insight

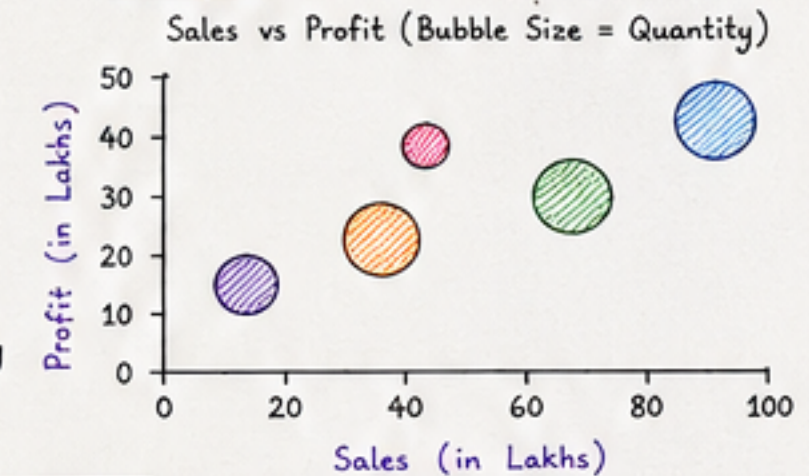
As discount increases, profit generally decreases. Heavy discounts may reduce profitability.

### 12. Bubble Chart (3 Variables)

#### When to Use?

- Similar to scatter chart but includes a third variable as bubble size.
- Shows relationship + magnitude.

#### Example:



#### Use Cases

- Sales vs Profit vs Quantity
- Revenue vs Customers vs Growth
- Product Performance Analysis

#### Key Insight

Product with high sales & high profit and large quantity is the top performer (blue bubble).

### Common Business Questions & Recommended Charts

| Business Question                       | Recommended Chart | Why this Chart?                       | Example Use Case                |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Which region generates highest revenue? | Column Chart      | Easy comparison of values.            | Revenue by Region               |
| What are our top 10 products?           | Bar Chart         | Handles long names & ranking.         | Top 10 Products by Sales        |
| Is revenue increasing over time?        | Line Chart        | Shows trend & direction.              | Monthly Revenue Trend           |
| Are we meeting our targets?             | Combo Chart       | Shows trend & direction.              | Actual vs Target Sales          |
| Where does our revenue come from?       | Pie / Doughnut    | Shows part-to-whole.                  | Revenue by Channel              |
| How did revenue become profit?          | Waterfall Chart   | Shows positive & negative impact.     | Revenue to Net Profit Bridge    |
| Does discount affect profit?            | Scatter Chart     | Shows relationship between variables. | Discount vs Profit              |
| How are amounts distributed?            | Histogram         | Shows frequency distribution.         | Transaction Amount Distribution |
| Are there any unusual transactions?     | Box & Whisker     | Identifies spread & outliers.         | Transaction Amount by Merchant  |
| Where are customers dropping off?       | Funnel Chart      | Shows stage-wise reduction.           | Lead to Customer Conversion     |
| Which category contributes most?        | Treemap Chart     | Shows hierarchy & contribution.       | Category → Subcategory Sales    |
| Which state has highest sales?          | Map Chart         | Visualizes data geographically.       | Sales by State                  |

#### Remember

- Right Chart = Clear Story
- Wrong Chart = Confusion
- Keep it Simple, Relevant & Impactful.

Data has a story,  
Charts help you  
tell it!



#### Pro Tip

Always begin with the business question.  
The question decides the chart,  
not the other way around.





### 13. Waterfall Chart (Variance / Bridge Analysis)

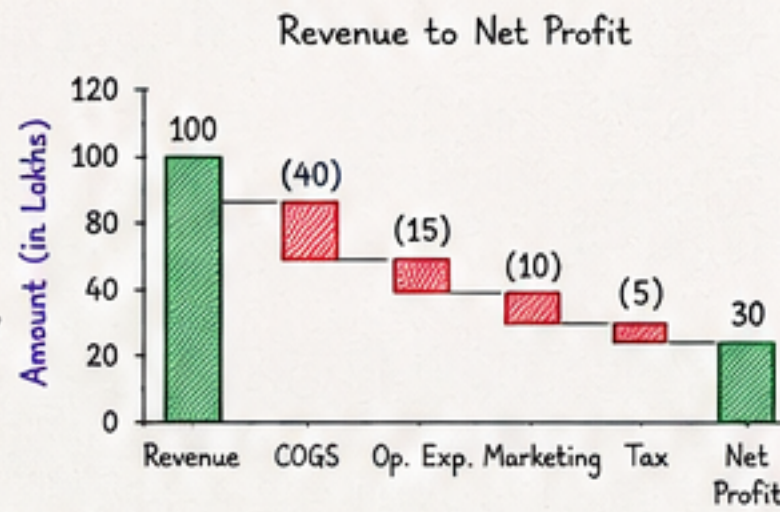
#### When to Use ?

- To show how an initial value changes due to positive and negative factors to reach a final value.
- Great for profit bridge, budget vs actual, cash flow analysis.

#### Use Cases

- Profit Analysis
- Budget vs Actual
- Cost Breakdown
- Cash Flow Analysis

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Shows how each expense reduces revenue to give final profit. Helps in cost control and decision making.

### 14. Scatter Chart (Relationship)

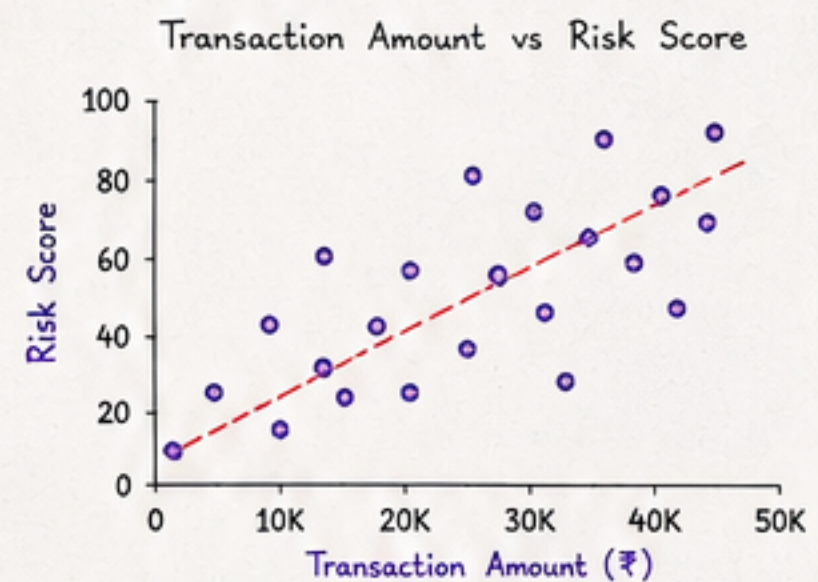
#### When to Use ?

- To analyze the relationship between two numeric variables.
- Helps find correlation, trends and outliers.

#### Use Cases

- Fraud Detection
- Risk Analysis
- Marketing Spend vs Sales
- Discount vs Profit

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Helps identify patterns and relationships. Used to predict outcomes and detect unusual data.

### 15. Histogram (Distribution)

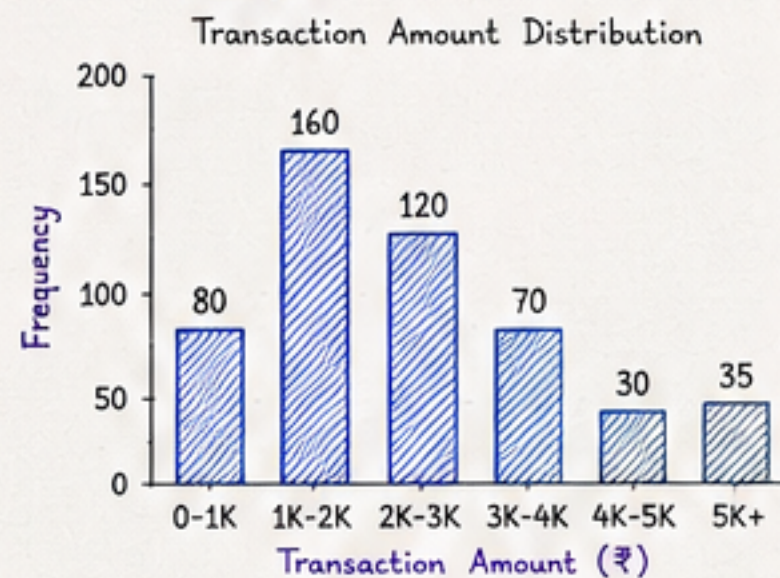
#### When to Use ?

- To show the distribution of a numeric variable.
- Data is grouped into ranges (bins) to see frequency.

#### Use Cases

- Transaction Amount
- Salary Distribution
- Customer Age
- Order Size Distribution

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Helps understand data spread and identify most common ranges (e.g., most transactions are between ₹1K-₹3K).

### 16. Box & Whisker Chart (Distribution & Outliers)

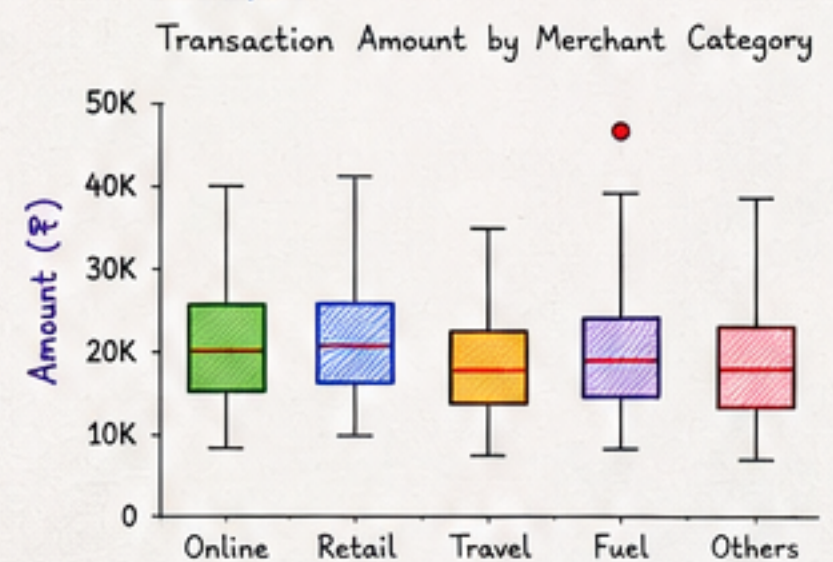
#### When to Use ?

- To compare distribution across categories.
- Shows median, quartiles, spread and outliers.
- Useful for detecting unusual values.

#### Use Cases

- Fraud Analysis
- Merchant Risk
- Salary Analysis
- Quality Control

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Shows median, spread and outliers. Helps in identifying categories with high variation or extreme values.

### 17. Funnel Chart (Stage Conversion)

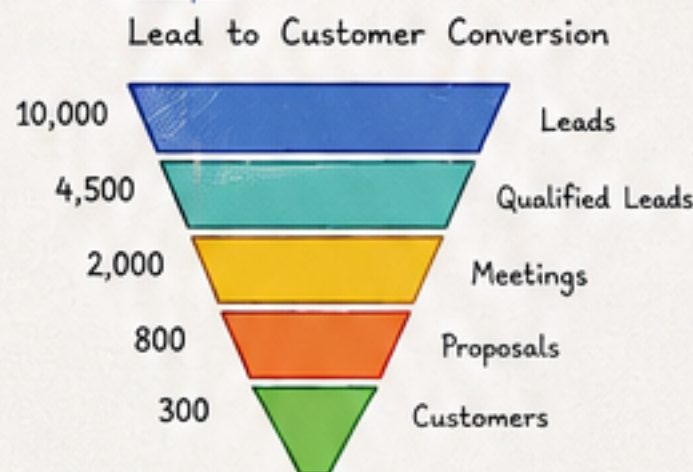
#### When to Use ?

- To show decrease in numbers across sequential stages of a process.
- Helps identify where drop-offs are happening.

#### Use Cases

- Sales Pipeline
- Recruitment Process
- Lead Generation
- Marketing Conversion

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Shows drop-offs at each stage. Helps improve the weakest step and increase final conversion.

### 18. Treemap (Hierarchical Contribution)

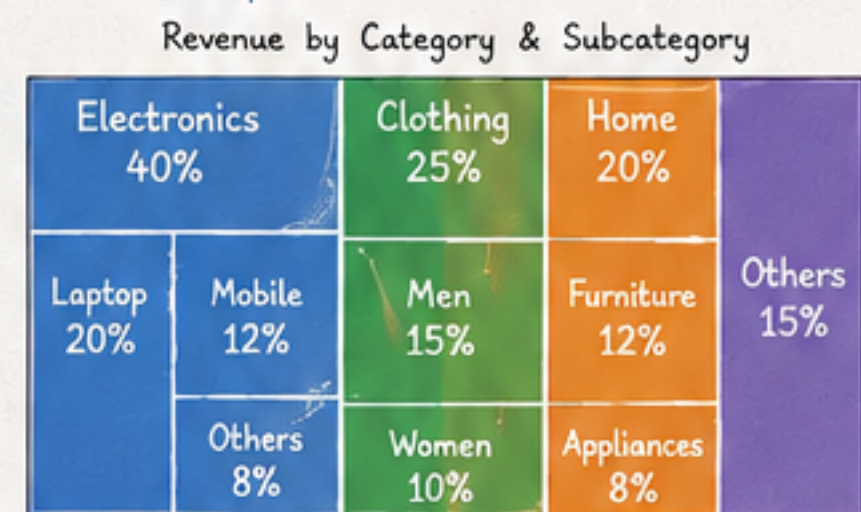
#### When to Use ?

- To show hierarchical data and contribution of subcategories.
- Space-efficient and easy to compare large categories.

#### Use Cases

- Category / Subcategory Sales
- Department Budget
- Inventory Analysis

#### Example



#### Key Insight

Shows part-to-whole hierarchy clearly. Helps find high value subcategories quickly.

### STAKEHOLDERS - WHO ARE THEY & WHAT THEY NEED

#### Stakeholders

- CEO / Leadership
- CFO (Finance)
- Sales Manager
- Marketing Manager
- Operations Manager
- HR Manager
- Risk / Fraud Team
- Investors / Board

#### What They Need

- ✓ High-level KPIs and trends
- ✓ Revenue, Profit, Growth, Targets
- ✓ Performance by region, product, period
- ✓ Risk and fraud insights
- ✓ Actionable insights for decision making
- ✓ Easy-to-understand visual reports
- ✓ Quick view with filters (Slicers, Timelines)

### TIPS FOR BETTER CHARTS

- ✓ Choose the right chart for the question
- ✓ Keep charts simple and clean
- ✓ Use meaningful titles and labels
- ✓ Highlight key insights
- ✓ Avoid 3D and too many colors
- ✓ Use Slicers & Timelines for interactivity
- ✓ Focus on business impact

#### PRO TIP

A good chart answers a question.  
A great chart tells a business story!



Remember: Right Chart + Right Insight = Better Decisions



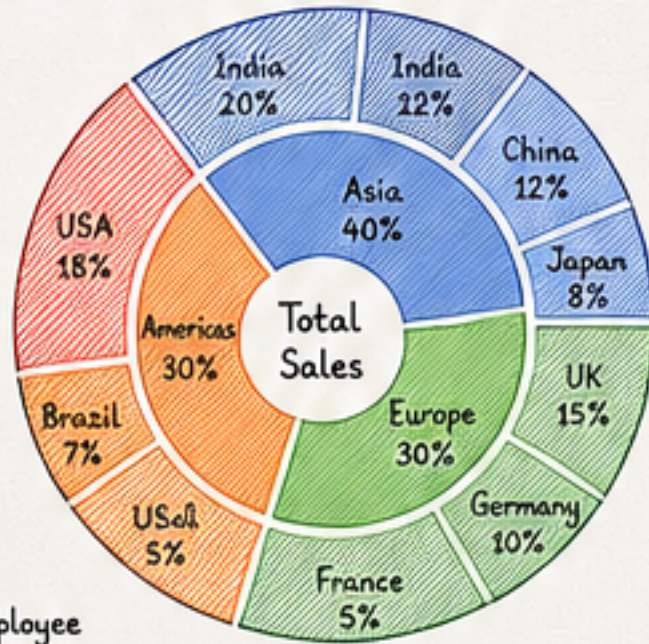


### 19. Sunburst Chart (Hierarchical Data)

#### When to Use?

- To show multi-level hierarchical data in a circular view.
- Best when hierarchy has 2 to 4 levels.

Example: Sales by Region → Country → City



#### Use Cases

- Region → Country → City
- Department → Team → Employee
- Category → Subcategory → Product



#### Key Insight

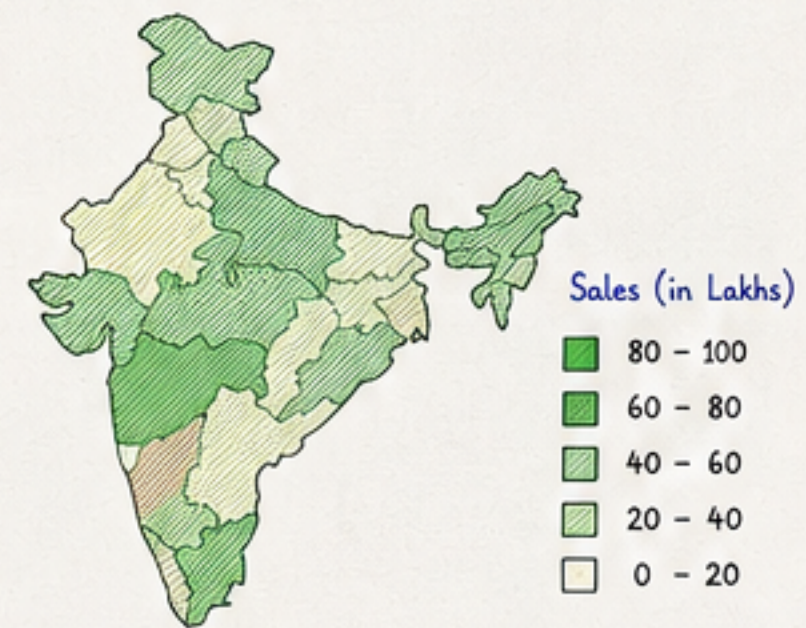
Asia contributes the most (40%), with India being the top city contributor (20%)

### 20. Map Chart (Geographical Analysis)

#### When to Use?

- To visualize data based on geographical locations.
- Helps in identifying high performing or risky areas.

Example: Sales by State



#### Use Cases

- Sales by State / Country
- Fraud by Location
- Store Performance by City
- Market Penetration

#### Key Insight

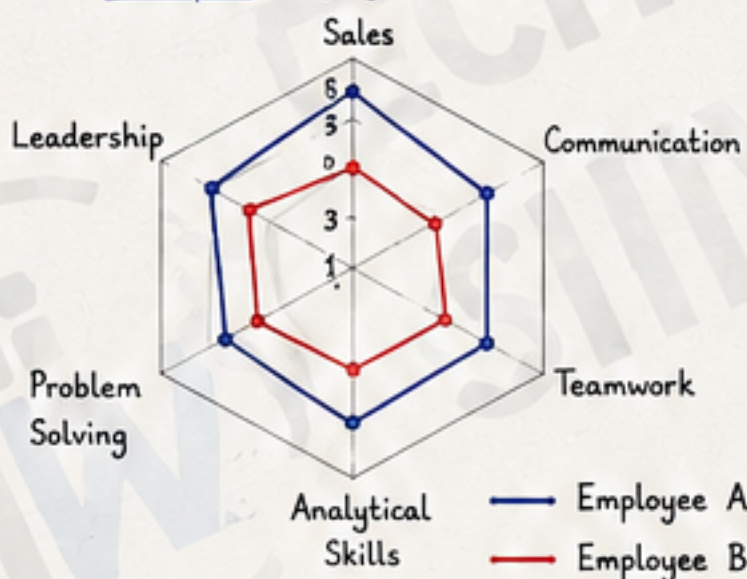
Maharashtra and Karnataka are top sales generating states.

### 21. Radar Chart (Multi-Metric Comparison)

#### When to Use?

- To compare multiple metrics for few items.
- Helps in performance comparison.

Example: Employee Performance



#### Use Cases

- Employee Performance
- Product Comparison
- Department Scorecard
- Skills Assessment

#### Key Insight

Employee A is strong in Sales and Leadership. Employee B is better in Communication and Teamwork.

### 22. Sparklines (Mini Charts in Cells)

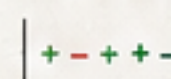
#### When to Use?

- To show small trends inside a cell.
- Perfect for dashboards and compact reports.

Example:

| Product | Jan | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Trend                                                                                 |
|---------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A       | 20  | 25  | 30  | 28  | 35  |  |
| B       | 15  | 18  | 22  | 24  | 27  |  |
| C       | 30  | 25  | 20  | 18  | 22  |  |
| D       | 10  | 12  | 15  | 14  | 16  |  |
| E       | 5   | 7   | 6   | 8   | 9   |  |

#### Types

- Line 
- Column 
- Win/Loss 

#### Key Insight

Product A has highest growth. Product C shows a declining trend.

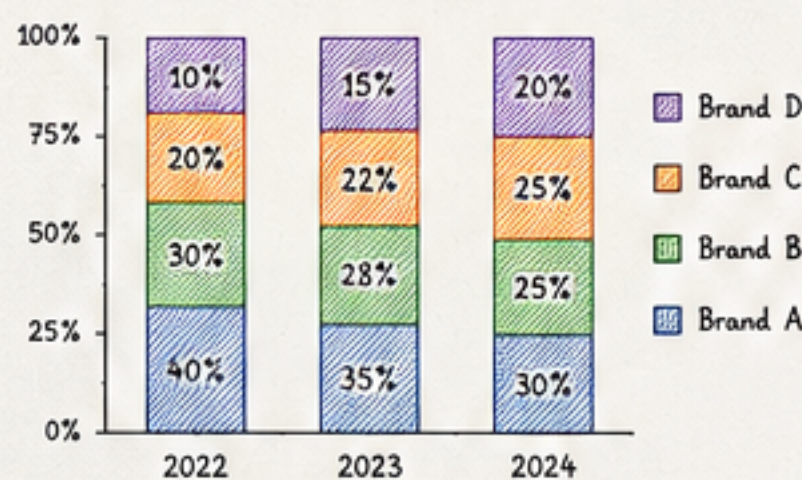


### 23. 100% Stacked Column Chart (Composition %)

#### When to Use?

- To compare percentage composition across categories.
- Total of each column is 100%.

Example: Market Share by Brand



#### Use Cases

- Market Share by Brand
- Channel Mix by Region
- Expense Mix by Month

#### Key Insight

Brand A market share is decreasing. Brand D is growing consistently.



### 24. KPI Card + Chart Combo (Dashboard View)

#### When to Use?

- To give quick overview with key numbers.
- Combine KPIs with charts for deeper insights.

Example Dashboard (Sample)



#### Use Cases

- Executive Dashboards
- Sales Performances
- Operations Monitoring
- Financial Reporting

### Why Right Chart Matters?

- ✓ Makes data easy to understand.
- ✓ Helps stakeholders take faster decisions.
- ✓ Highlights important insights clearly.
- ✓ Improves the impact of your report.
- ✓ Tells a story, not just shows numbers.

### Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ✗ Using pie chart for too many categories.
- ✗ Choosing complex charts unnecessarily.
- ✗ No chart title or wrong title.
- ✗ Missing labels, units, or source.
- ✗ Too many colors and clutter.
- ✗ Not focusing on the business question.

### Remember

The best chart is not the most beautiful one, It is the one that answers the business question in the simplest way.





# BUSINESS CHARTS IN EXCEL

For Stakeholder Reporting & Data Storytelling



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## 25. Pivot Charts - What & Why?

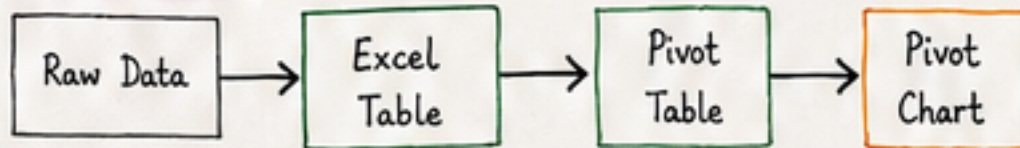
### What is it?

- A chart connected to a Pivot Table.
- Any change in Pivot Table (filter, slicer, timeline) automatically updates the chart.

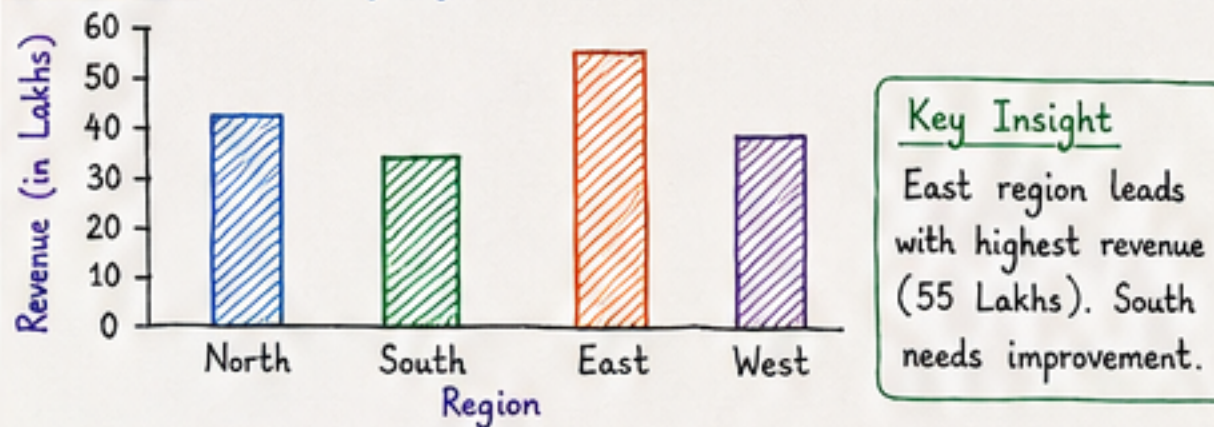
### Why Use?

- ✓ Interactive
- ✓ Easy Analysis
- ✓ Quick Insights
- ✓ Perfect for dashboards

### How it Works?



### Example: Sales by Region



**Tip:** Use Slicers & Timelines with Pivot Charts for dynamic dashboard experience.

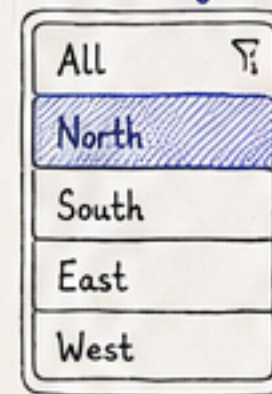
## 26. Slicers & Timelines - What & Why?

### Slicers

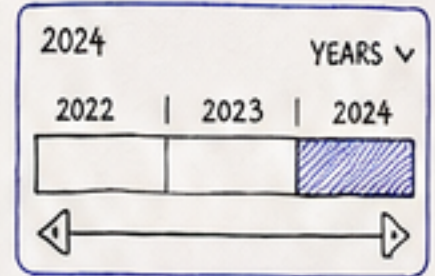
- Filter data visually.
- Works on text / categorical fields.
- Easy to use buttons.

### Example:

#### Slicer (Region)



#### Timeline (Order Date)



### Timelines

- Filter date fields.
- Drill down by Years, Quarters, Months, Days.
- Perfect for time based analysis.

### Why Important?

- ★ One click filtering
- ★ Better user experience
- ★ Helps stakeholders explore data easily
- ★ Makes reports interactive & professional

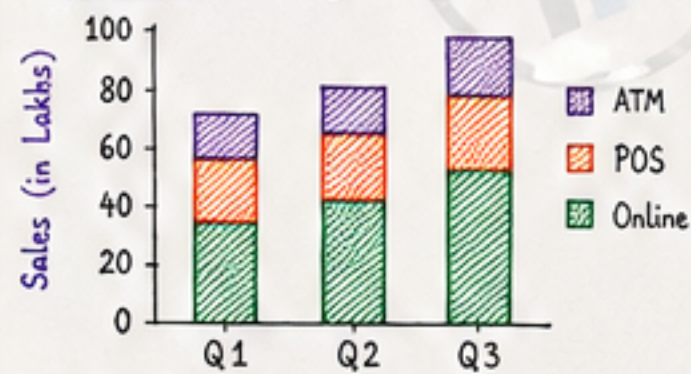


## 27. Stacked Column vs 100% Stacked Column

### Stacked Column (Absolute Composition)

- Shows total value & contribution.
- Good when we care about actual numbers.

### Example: Sales by Channel



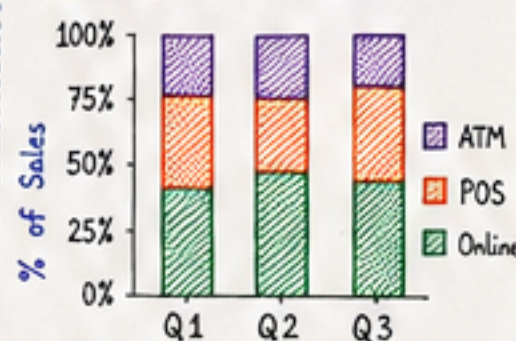
### Key Insight

Online contributes most in all quarters. Q3 has highest total sales.

### 100% Stacked Column (Composition %)

- Shows percentage mix.
- Good when comparing proportions.

### Example: Sales Mix %



### Key Insight

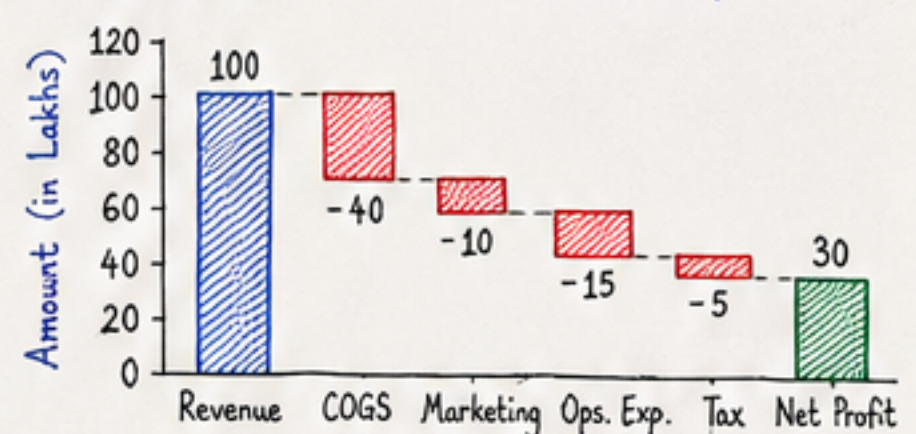
Online share increased in Q3. ATM share is decreasing.

## 28. Waterfall Chart - Bridge / Variance Analysis

### When to Use?

- To show how a value changes from start to end.
- Excellent for profit bridge, budget vs actual, cash flow.
- Shows positive & negative contributions clearly.

### Example: Revenue to Net Profit Bridge



### Key Insight

From 100 Lakhs revenue, after all expenses, we are left with 30 Lakhs net profit.

### Use Cases

- Revenue to Profit Analysis
- Budget to Actual Variance
- Cash Flow Statement
- Year over Year Changes

### Remember!

Waterfall tells the **STORY** behind the numbers.



## CHART SELECTION GUIDE (Quick Reference)

| Analytical Need          | Best Chart          | Why?                             |
|--------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|
| Compare categories       | Column Chart        | Easy height comparison           |
| Rank many items          | Bar Chart           | Better labels & ranking          |
| Trend over time          | Line Chart          | Shows pattern & direction        |
| Actual vs Target         | Combo Chart         | Compare two metrics              |
| Part-to-Whole (few cats) | Pie / Donut         | Show contribution                |
| Composition (absolute)   | Stacked Column      | Total + components               |
| Composition (percentage) | 100% Stacked Column | Compare % mix                    |
| Variance / Bridge        | Waterfall Chart     | Shows how value changes          |
| Relationship             | Scatter Chart       | Find correlation & outliers      |
| Distribution             | Histogram           | Shows frequency distribution     |
| Outliers / Spread        | Box & Whisker       | Compare spread & detect outliers |
| Conversion (Stages)      | Funnel Chart        | Show drop-offs                   |
| Hierarchical Data        | Treemap / Sunburst  | Show hierarchy & size            |
| Geographical Data        | Map Chart           | Visualize by location            |
| Multi-Metric Compare     | Radar Chart         | Compare profiles                 |

## DASHBOARD FLOW (Story Structure)

- What Happened?**  
KPI Cards (Revenue, Profit, Orders, Customers, Fraud Rate)
- Where Did It Happen?**  
Region, Channel, Category, Product
- When Did It Happen?**  
Trends (Monthly, Quarterly, YoY)
- Why Did It Happen?**  
Drivers (Discount, Channel, Product, Customer Behaviour)

This flow creates a strong story for stakeholders.

## BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Keep it simple & clean
- ✓ Use right chart for the right question
- ✓ Avoid 3D, heavy colors & clutter
- ✓ Add meaningful titles & labels
- ✓ Highlight key insights
- ✓ Use consistent colors
- ✓ Limit number of charts per dashboard
- ✓ Use slicers & timelines for interactivity
- ✓ Focus on business impact, not decoration

## FINAL THOUGHT

A great chart doesn't just show data, it helps stakeholders make better decisions.



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### 29. INTERVIEW QUESTIONS - CHART SELECTION

| Q.No. | Business Question                                  | Recommended Chart         | Why this Chart?                                   |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| ①     | Which region generated the highest revenue?        | Column Chart              | Easy comparison of values across regions.         |
| ②     | Top 10 products by sales amount?                   | Bar Chart                 | Better ranking & easy to read long labels.        |
| ③     | Is revenue increasing over time?                   | Line Chart                | Shows trend & direction clearly.                  |
| ④     | Actual sales vs target sales by month?             | Combo Chart               | Comparing two metrics with different scales.      |
| ⑤     | How is revenue split by product category?          | Pie / Doughnut Chart      | Shows part-to-whole contribution.                 |
| ⑥     | Sales by region and channel?                       | Stacked Column Chart      | Shows total & composition together.               |
| ⑦     | Percentage contribution of channel in each region? | 100% Stacked Column Chart | Compares proportional composition.                |
| ⑧     | How did profit change from last year?              | Waterfall Chart           | Shows positive & negative variances step-by-step. |
| ⑨     | Is discount affecting profit?                      | Scatter Chart             | Shows relationship between two variables.         |
| ⑩     | What is the distribution of order value?           | Histogram                 | Shows frequency distribution of values.           |
| ⑪     | Are there outliers in transaction amounts?         | Box & Whisker Chart       | Identifies spread, median & outliers.             |
| ⑫     | Where are most fraud transactions coming from?     | Map Chart                 | Shows data based on geography.                    |

### 30. DASHBOARD LAYOUT - EXAMPLE.

Business Scenario: Fraud & Transaction Dashboard

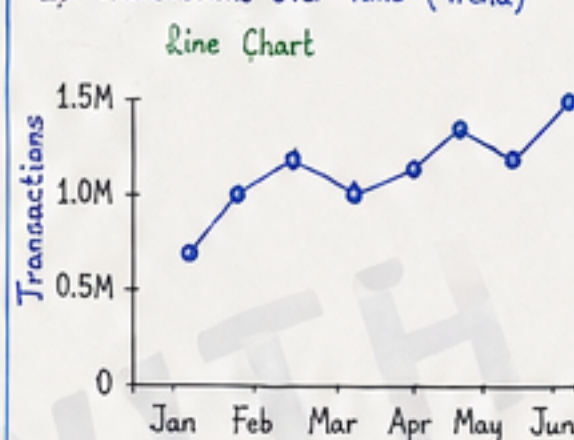
#### KPI CARDS (Top Summary)

|                                            |                                          |                                            |                                   |                                           |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Total Transactions<br>5.2 M<br>↑ 12% vs LY | Total Revenue<br>₹ 125 Cr<br>↑ 18% vs LY | Fraud Transactions<br>16,540<br>↑ 8% vs LY | Fraud Rate<br>0.32%<br>↓ 2% vs LY | Avg. Ticket Size<br>₹ 2,405<br>↑ 5% vs LY |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|

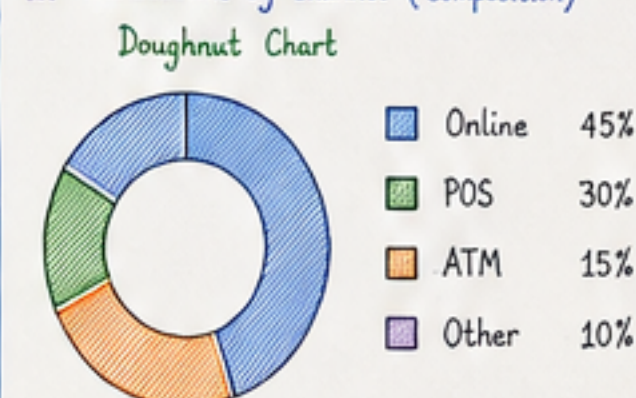
#### FILTERS (Slicers & Timelines)

| Slicers   |                   |                  | Timeline (Order Date) |           |
|-----------|-------------------|------------------|-----------------------|-----------|
| Region    | Channel           | Transaction Type | YEARS                 |           |
| Card Type | Merchant Category | Payment Method   | 2022                  | 2023 2024 |

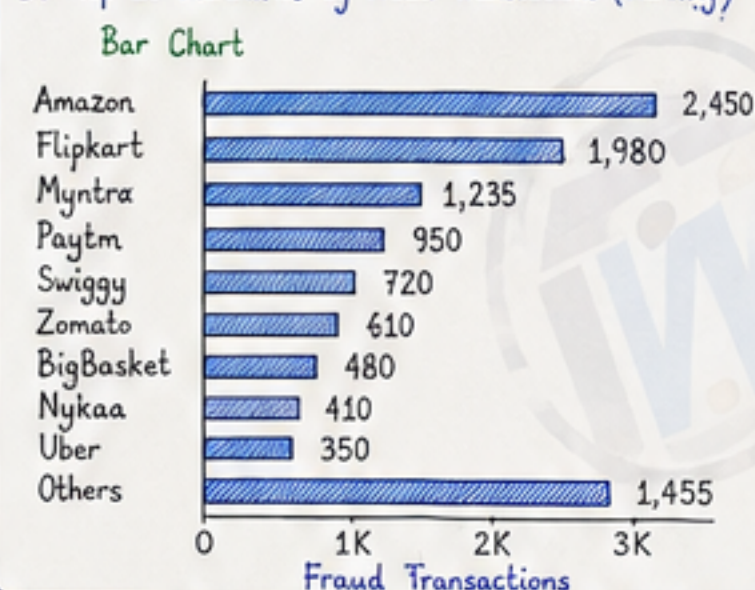
#### 1. Transactions Over Time (Trend)



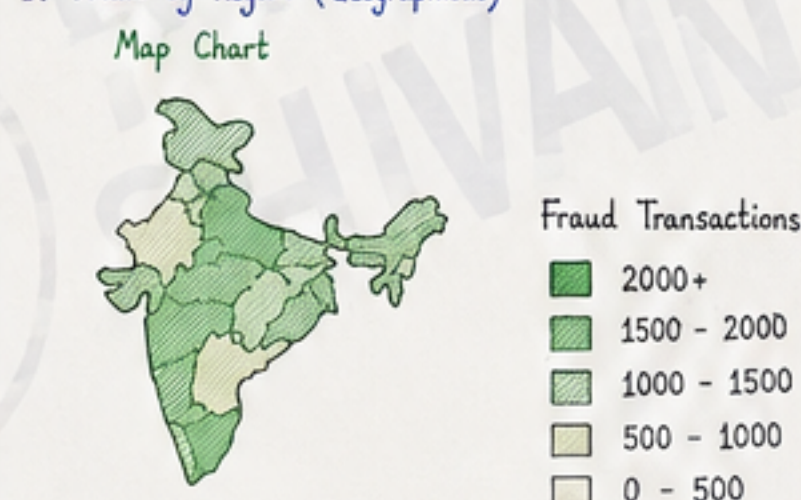
#### 2. Transactions by Channel (Composition)



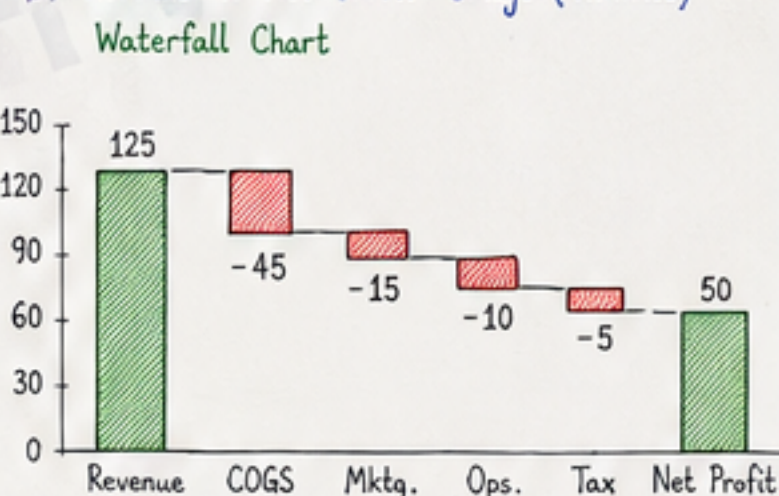
#### 3. Top 10 Merchants by Fraud Transactions (Ranking)



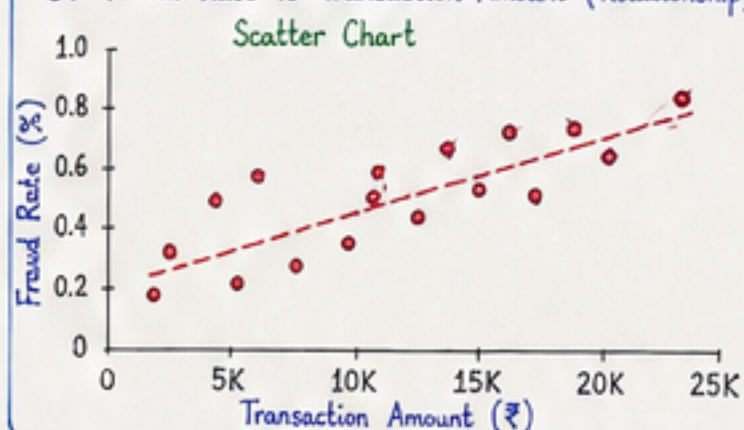
#### 4. Fraud by Region (Geographical)



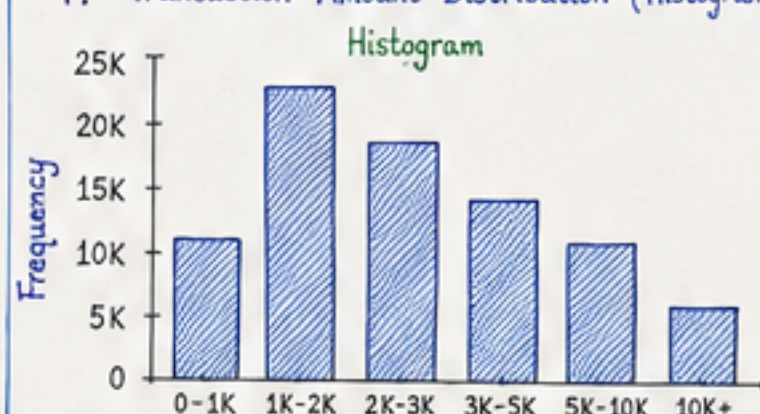
#### 5. Revenue to Net Profit Bridge (Variance)



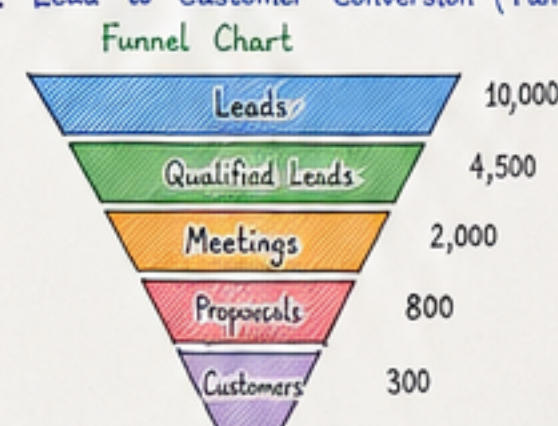
#### 6. Fraud Rate vs Transaction Amount (Relationship)



#### 7. Transaction Amount Distribution (Histogram)



#### 8. Lead to Customer Conversion (Funnel)



### 31. CHART SELECTION - QUICK ANSWER GUIDE

|                          |   |                     |
|--------------------------|---|---------------------|
| Compare categories       | → | Column Chart        |
| Rank many items          | → | Bar Chart           |
| Trend over time          | → | Line Chart          |
| Two metrics together     | → | Combo Chart         |
| Part-to-Whole            | → | Pie / Doughnut      |
| Composition (Absolute)   | → | Stacked Column      |
| Composition (Percentage) | → | 100% Stacked Column |
| Variance / Bridge        | → | Waterfall Chart     |
| Relationship             | → | Scatter Chart       |
| Distribution             | → | Histogram           |
| Outliers / Spread        | → | Box & Whisker       |
| Stage Conversion         | → | Funnel Chart        |
| Hierarchical Data        | → | Treemap / Sunburst  |
| Geographical Data        | → | Map Chart           |
| Multi-Metric Compare     | → | Radar Chart         |

Choose the simplest chart that answers the business question clearly.

### 32. PRACTICE SCENARIO - ANSWERS

| Scenario (Business Question)              | Best Chart      | Why?                                 | Key Insight (Possible)                          |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| ① Monthly revenue growth for last 3 years | Line Chart      | Shows trend over time                | Revenue is growing consistently.                |
| ② Top 10 Cities by sales                  | Bar Chart       | Better for ranking many items        | Mumbai, Delhi & Bengaluru are top sales cities. |
| ③ Revenue vs Profit Margin by Quarter     | Combo Chart     | Two metrics with different scales    | Profit margin improved in Q4.                   |
| ④ Sales contribution by product category  | Pie Chart       | Part-to-whole contribution           | Electronics contributes 35% of total sales.     |
| ⑤ Profit change from last year            | Waterfall Chart | Shows positive & negative variances  | Marketing expense increased profit decline.     |
| ⑥ Discount impact on profit               | Scatter Chart   | Shows relationship between variables | Higher discount is linked to lower profit.      |

#### Remember

The right chart turns data into insight and insight into action.